



Write to the Editor

E-mail: editor@thinkdigit.com

Snail Mail: The Editor, Digit, D-222/2, Om Sagar Building, MIDC, TTC Industrial Estate, Nerul, Navi Mumbai 400 706

Digit will publish the best letters on these pages. Letters may be edited for clarity. **You must include your complete address in all communication.**

For subscription queries, call the Help Desk at 022-27629191/9200, Fax 022-27629224, or send an e-mail to help@jasubhai.com

Inbox

Regarding full versions of games, well, we cannot pass on illegal copies of games! The results of the Digit Contest Carnival are regularly updated at zdnetindia.com/dcnew.

—Associate Editor

Digit Patron—Double The Value!

First up, you deserve my thanks - in fact, a thousand thanks! I am a computer teacher, and I'm a regular bus-stand reader of *Digit*. When I first saw a mention of "Digit Patron" in the magazine, I thought it was only for subscribers—but, of course, I was mistaken. I got my gift a few days ago—the "Photoshop 100%" edition. It was amazing! Digit Patron is an amazing and useful program—it doubles *Digit*'s value!

I have a few suggestions for forthcoming issues:

It is time to introduce another issue of "Photoshop 100%". We now have Photoshop 9, with lots of new features, meaning new possibilities for graphics.

I suggest you include some free demo filters in the CD/DVD, and also some useful Photoshop templates and other resources.

Everyone likes Mini CDs—they are easy to handle. I know the capacity is low, but I'd suggest you try a Mini CD at least in the Anniversary Edition. You can include PDF files on that CD.

Since you include a lot of PDF files, I'd request you to include some general-knowledge related papers. It will be of great help to children and students.

Manoj A P
Malappuram

Dear Manoj,

Thanks for your kind words about the Digit Patron programme. And keep the suggestions coming—we may or may not be able to implement all the suggestions we receive from our readers, but we're always listening!

—Associate Editor

No Extreme Pack?!

I received the December issue, but not the full "extreme" pack. You've sent us subscribers a letter explaining why, but I don't agree with you.

Your magazine has ads from so many companies—including international giants such as Samsung, Seiko, HP, and more—and I'm sure you get a lot of money from them. It should be very easy for you to pass on the benefits at least to regular subscribers like me.

I was shocked to find that even the

calendar wasn't there—which even small local firms give away for free!

I request you to kindly consider my viewpoint again, and see to it that subscribers are sent the items free, as should have been done. However, if that is not possible, the least you can do is send the calendar with the next issue.

M Yasin Ganaie
via e-mail

Why The Rs 50?

We subscribers were waiting for your special CDs, and received your letter asking for more money, in the second half of the month. It is not good practice or fair business to ask for money after you have agreed upon certain conditions.

In your special issue, you have added a lot of ads and ad-oriented articles—at the expense of regular tech features. You added free CDs to boost your sales. Also, you want to beat your competitor, who comes up with three CDs and three DVDs, on their ground. Why are you doing this at our expense? Your competitor delivered additional CDs at no extra cost. And you are asking for Rs 50 to meet your additional expenses.

Anyway, it was very disappointing to read your letter. I am declining your offer. I will go to the bookstall and get a copy.

Vincent Abraham
via e-mail

Dear Yasin and Vincent,

We simply could not afford to send subscribers the extras that came with the December issue. Subscribers received all the regular content, including the special issue magazine at the reduced price they paid when they subscribed.

You get the magazine at a significantly lower cost—especially after the price hike. We have subscribers like you who subscribed when it was one magazine and two CDs. Today, for the same price, despite inflation and rising costs, we provide them with one magazine, one DVD, one CD, and a useful 200-page Fast Track book.

In addition, we must stress that we made no money at all from the extra Rs 50—it only covered royalties and courier charges.

While we can look at the situation from your viewpoint, I request you to look at it from ours.

—Associate Editor

The Gimp Rules!

This is my first letter to you, though I should have thanked you a long time ago! I have learnt a lot about technology, computing, gadgets and more from *Digit*, and it's due to *Digit* that I'm interested in learning more.

Two months ago, the Fast track series on essential Windows tools covered Photobie, Paintbox, and Picasa, which was great. But I was disappointed to not find the most powerful open source image editing software—The Gimp. This is the only free software that can pose a challenge to and compete with Adobe Photoshop. Its interface is cluttered for beginners, but once you play around you're comfortable.

Gimp 2.2.8 is very stable. I have used it for image editing, colorization, etc. and it has never disappointed me. The Gimp Web site has numerous colourful, illustrated tutorials and user manuals—all you need is a little time and attention to master it. Please include a review of and a tutorial on The Gimp in a forthcoming issue—because *Digit* can bring credibility and interest to the least-known program! Might I also request you to include the installer (along with GTK+) on the CD/DVD?

Photobie is a nice program, but the icons are sluggish, and there are no tool tips for many icons. I'd suggest the author make it open source so it gets developed in no time! By doing so, its creator will soon get famous—the way people remember Ton Roosendal of Blender 3D (a very feature rich 3D animation tool), Peter Mattis and Spencer Kimball of Gimp, Irfan Skiljan of Irfan View, and many others.

Jagadish Bhargava
Bangalore

Dear Jagadish,

You must have missed it—we did carry a tutorial on The Gimp in our Q&A section of the last issue (December 2005), taking into consideration the usefulness of the software. And as for giving out the installer, well, we can certainly consider your request.

—Associate Editor

LETTER
OF THE
MONTH